



◀ HARD DISK DRIVES: WD VELOCIRAPTOR

Price: ₹15,765

Hard Drives

The shifting focus of having easily accessible data at all times on the cloud has led to a stagnation when it comes to innovation in the consumer HDD segment. Obviously more focus is on enterprise drives since that's what cloud storage data centres make use of. We have seen the SATA 3.2 revision bringing in newer interfaces but not much is being done by hard drive manufacturers to take advantage of that. SSDs are slowly gaining popularity and with declining PC sales manufacturers no longer have a wide supply-demand gap. Yet, every now and then we get to see a sliver of innovation. SSHDs are part of that sliver. These hybrids are yet to achieve mainstream popularity but that won't be for too long.

Zero1 Winner WD Velociraptor

Last year's winner takes the crown yet again. This particular Velociraptor, the WD1000DHTZ was introduced in 2012 and is yet to be beaten by any other drive. SSHDs do come close and even get ahead when it comes to seek time (read/write) but when looking at the overall performance the Velociraptor comes out in the lead. Hopefully, the next year should see some decent improvement in SSHD technology which may lose WD its crown.

Worthy Mentions Seagate SSHD

Seagate has been leading the way when it comes to SSHDs. WD and Toshiba have hybrid drives in the market but not with performance as consistent as Seagate offers. Toshiba drives offer better read speeds but they only offer 2.5-inch variants while Seagate caters to the 3.5-inch desktop market as well.



Seagate SSHD

Price: ₹9,200 (2TB)



SanDisk Extreme II

Price: ₹7,500 (120GB)



Plextor M6s

Price: ₹4,399 (128GB)

Solid State Drives

Solid State Drives have improved on all fronts this year, be it speed, capacity, durability or form factors. The one change that deserves the biggest mention is that of 3D V-NAND. We've seen Intel come up with 3D transistors and it was only natural that it was to be replicated across all implementations. This means more capacity thanks to the stacking; and lower power consumption.

Zero1 Winner Samsung 850 Pro

Being a manufacturer of NAND chips gives a brand complete freedom over innovation. The 850 Pro is the first to implement 3D V NAND and we'll be seeing the 850 Evo having the same chips as well. This potent combination gives Samsung a clear edge over its competitors, outperforming every SSD we've tested this year by a long margin. What's more, with the increased TBW (Total Bytes Written) capacity of 3D V NANDs the durability of these SSDs is insane – Samsung is offering a 10 year warranty on the 850 Pro.

Worth Mentions SanDisk Extreme II

Close on the heels of the 850 Pro is the SanDisk Extreme II which won our recently conducted SSD benchmark comparison test. Very good, this SSD!

Plextor M6s

With just a minor drop in performance and a not so minor drop in price is the Plextor M6s. If you aren't fussy about losing out on performance by a small margin to get more storage space, grab this one. **d**



▲ SOLID STATE DRIVES: SAMSUNG 850 PRO

Price: ₹7,999 (128GB)